

William Barents

Senior Frontend / Full-Stack Engineer

wbarents84@gmail.com · +27 61 156 2717

williambarents.com

Johannesburg, SA · EU / ZA Citizen

Senior engineer with 5+ years of production experience building complex SaaS platforms and fintech systems for international remote teams. Trusted with end-to-end ownership of security-sensitive systems — from architecture through deployment and live support. Founded and built **Zyneera**, a multi-tenant procurement SaaS, from zero. Equally at home leading frontend architecture, designing backend data models, and operating cloud infrastructure. EU citizen — no visa sponsorship required — available immediately for remote European roles.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder & Chief Technology Officer

2025 – Present

Zyneera · Self-employed, Johannesburg SA · React · Firebase · Paystack · Resend

- Founded and architected a multi-tenant SaaS procurement and execution platform for the events industry — connecting event planners and vendors in a single controlled ecosystem.
- Designed the full system architecture: React frontend, Firebase Firestore for real-time data, Cloud Functions for backend logic, Firebase Auth for identity, and RBAC for multi-tenant access control.
- Built core platform features from scratch: real-time messaging between planners and vendors, a ticketing and workflow engine, subscription-based feature gating, and a complete vendor/planner role separation model.
- Integrated Paystack for payment processing, subscription billing, and vendor payouts — handling real financial transactions in production.
- Integrated Resend for transactional email infrastructure (invitations, confirmations, notifications).
- Modelled and optimised Firestore data structures for performance, cost efficiency, and query speed across a multi-tenant dataset.
- Sole engineer — responsible for product decisions, infrastructure, security, CI/CD, and ongoing iteration.

Senior Frontend Engineer

2023 – 2026

MCE Group · Contract · Remote, Netherlands · Angular · React · Firebase · GCP · TypeScript

- Owned full frontend and backend delivery of a production-grade financial operations dashboard — used daily to manage API keys, wallet addresses, trade data exports, and cross-exchange analytics.
- Designed a security-first credential architecture: all secrets stored in Google Secret Manager with only non-sensitive metadata in Firestore, creating a clean separation that reduced risk and simplified compliance.
- Integrated APIs from multiple cryptocurrency exchanges, including bespoke implementations for exchanges with no official SDK support — requiring deep reverse-engineering and robust error handling.
- Configured an IP-NAT VPC (DigitalOcean) to route all outbound traffic through a static IP, unlocking access to exchanges that enforce strict IP allowlists.
- Built live wallet balance monitoring and token price tracking using on-chain blockchain data providers, with configurable threshold alerts delivered via email — replacing reactive manual checks.
- Implemented fine-grained RBAC: admins could manage user roles and revoke access instantly, giving the operations team full governance over system access.
- Built and maintained Telegram bots that automated operational workflows, monitoring alerts, and internal notifications — significantly

CONTACT

✉ wbarents84@gmail.com

☎ +27 61 156 2717

🌐 williambarents.com

📍 Johannesburg, SA

STATUS

Available immediately

Remote only

EU / ZA dual citizen

No visa needed · EU eligible

CORE SKILLS

FRONTEND

React, Angular, TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML5, CSS3 / SCSS

BACKEND

Firebase Cloud Functions, REST API design & integration, Node.js

DATABASE

Firestore (data modelling, multi-tenant schemas, query optimisation)

AUTH & SECURITY

Firebase Auth, RBAC, Google Secret Manager, credential separation

CLOUD & INFRA

GCP, DigitalOcean, IP-NAT VPC, Docker, CI/CD pipelines

PAYMENTS

Paystack (subscriptions, payouts, webhooks)

REALTIME

Firestore live sync, WebSockets, event-driven architecture

TOOLING

Git, GitHub, Google Analytics, DigitalOcean Spaces

INTEGRATIONS

Exchange APIs, blockchain data providers, Telegram Bot API, Resend

STRENGTHS

reducing manual overhead.

- Delivered parallel workstreams: a web3 news aggregation platform, multiple frontend redesigns for subsidiary web apps, and an internal backend portfolio content management system.
- Worked in a fully remote async team, collaborating across timezones with designers, a product manager, and backend engineers through the full feature lifecycle.

Frontend Engineer

2022 – 2023

Youwe · Freelance · Remote, Netherlands · React · Next.js · JavaScript · CSS3

- Delivered production e-commerce features in a fast-paced Agile environment, collaborating with designers, product owners, and backend engineers across tight sprint cycles.
- Led a complete mobile-first frontend redesign — restructuring component architecture, improving performance, and aligning to modern UX/UI standards.
- Built and optimised product listing pages and checkout flows for responsiveness, accessibility (WCAG), and conversion rate.
- Developed reusable component library and custom CMS content blocks that empowered non-technical editors to manage content independently.
- Diagnosed and resolved complex frontend bugs across JavaScript, DOM behaviour, and CSS — maintaining a high-quality codebase under deadline pressure.
- Contributed to the early adoption of React and Next.js as part of a strategic move toward headless commerce architecture.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Microsoft Certified Professional (MCP)

HTML5, JavaScript, CSS3 · IT Academy, Cape Town
MTA: Database Fundamentals · Microsoft Technology Associate

2018

National Senior Certificate

Bryanston High School, Johannesburg

2016

- End-to-end ownership — from whiteboard to production
- Security-first engineering mindset
- Founder experience — product thinking + execution
- Remote-native — 4+ years async international teams
- Fast learner who internalises, not just copies
- Ships, follows through, leaves things better

LANGUAGES

English
Fluent (professional)
Dutch
Basic (working knowledge)

REFERENCES

Eddy Örszik
CTO · MCE Group
odon@mceg.io
Wesley Russon
COO · MCO Group
wesley@mceg.io